

Chapter 160-1 Extra Chapter Two

Ning Fuyi closed her mouth that had been hanging open and looked at Chu Qingqiu: "This hairpin isn't..."

Chu Qingqiu silently reached out, taking something from her waist, and held it up alongside that hairpin. Both items were identical in every detail, from their overall shape and jade color to the cotton-like threads within the jade pendant.

This hairpin had been buried with Su Mo in the tomb after her death. Later, when Chu Qingqiu's soul returned to her immortal body, she had returned to the grave and retrieved this hairpin.

But how could there suddenly be another one now?

Both could see the shock in each other's eyes. Finally, Chu Qingqiu cupped her palm slightly and put the hairpin away.

"Is that woman still at the foot of the mountain?" Chu Qingqiu asked.

"Take this venerable one to see for herself," Chu Qingqiu said.

Ning Fuyi followed behind Chu Qingqiu and Elder Pingyao all the way down the mountain. Her mind was somewhat muddled at this moment, as if something was about to emerge, but she quickly dismissed it as fantasy.

Su Mo was already dead. No, Su Mo was right beside her now—how could there be a second one?

Or perhaps it was someone's prank. That Jiuying had always feared the world wasn't chaotic enough, so doing such things wouldn't be surprising. However, others who saw this jade hairpin would only glance at it casually—how could they replicate one that was identical in every way?

The more she pondered, the tighter Ning Fuyi's heart became. Just then, they had descended the long steps leading into the clouds of Cloud Ascension Mountain and arrived at the stone gate.

There indeed stood a woman in blue robes on the stone platform, with a cluster of purple bamboo beside her. She appeared as slender as the purple bamboo itself, with half her hair bound in a topknot and half flowing loose like silk.

The moment she saw the woman, Ning Fuyi felt as if struck by lightning. Her feet immediately gave way, and only Pingyao's quick reflexes in supporting her prevented her from tumbling down the steps.

Chu Qingqiu was also stunned. She stood motionless in place, her gaze unable to move away from the woman's shoulders.

People cannot actually see their own complete appearance clearly, so the woman's figure was somewhat unfamiliar to Chu Qingqiu, yet more familiar than anyone else in the world. Chu Qingqiu stood there as if in a dream, while standing opposite was herself.

"Yiyi..." The woman's mouth opened slightly, fragmented sounds squeezing from her lips. Then her eyes lit up with radiance, and she suddenly lifted her skirt and ran toward Ning Fuyi with large strides.

Before Ning Fuyi could react, the woman had already crashed into her embrace. At the moment of skin contact, those soft arms tightly encircled her, as if something lost had been regained.

"Yiyi..." she murmured with effort, her heart filled with the joy of seeing her beloved again.

Ning Fuyi hadn't yet emerged from her shock, but her hands involuntarily rose to gently embrace the woman's thin shoulders and back, while her eyes instinctively sought out Chu Qingqiu.

Seeing this scene, Chu Qingqiu clenched her sleeves tightly, her eyes seeming to contain an overturned spice rack, too complex to understand.

Half an incense stick's time later, Ning Fuyi had calmed the woman who had obviously traveled a long way in fear and brought her back to the Tranquil Mountain Palace. At the same time, to avoid causing an uproar in the mountain gate, she asked Elder Pingyao to issue a prohibition, claiming that the Divine Venerable was in closed-door cultivation, and for three days, no disciples were allowed to approach the Tranquil Mountain Palace.

After arranging all this, Ning Fuyi finally closed the gates of the Tranquil Mountain Palace and notified Jiuying to come quickly.

In the lakeside pavilion of the Tranquil Mountain Palace, Ning Fuyi, Chu Qingqiu, Jiuying, and Jiang Li stood in a circle, silently watching the trembling woman surrounded in their midst.

"Yiyi..." Su Mo was frightened by this formation, her hand involuntarily reaching to pull at Ning Fuyi's sleeve. But then, seeing Chu Qingqiu's stern face, her hand loosened and dropped to her side.

She spoke no more, only her gaze still couldn't move away from Ning Fuyi.

"You say she appeared out of thin air?" Jiang Li had obviously never witnessed such a supernatural event, her hand almost wearing out the round fan in her palm. "But her physical body has already decayed, and her soul has returned to its original place. How could there still be another Su Mo in the world?"

"Could it be someone impersonating her?" Jiang Li reached out to examine her but was stopped by Jiuying, who grabbed her wrist.

"No, I can smell her scent. She's mortal, and she is Su Mo." Jiuying was also puzzled.

Ning Fuyi, who had remained silent, met Su Mo's eyes that held pools of clear water, and her heart immediately softened. She raised her hand to signal the other two not to frighten her, then placed her hands in front of her chest and began to gesture.

"Are you Su Mo?"

Su Mo stared at her and nodded.

"Where did you come from, and why did you appear at the Cloud Ascension Mountain gate?"

Su Mo glanced at Chu Qingqiu before raising her hands to answer: "I don't know why. I was originally in your arms, watching snow, but I was very sleepy, so I slept."

"When I woke up again, you and the snow were both gone, leaving only our wooden house. I saw my grave."

"I seemed not to have died. But there was no one in the wooden house. I couldn't wait for you, so I took your portrait and asked around. An immortal elder told me you were at Cloud Ascension Mountain, so I came to find you."

She spoke haltingly, half gesturing and half speaking. When she lowered her hands, everyone's eyes showed undisguised shock.

Ning Fuyi's expression was complex and indecipherable. She suddenly stepped forward, guiding Su Mo to sit down, then lifted her leg and removed the worn cloth shoes from her feet. As expected, those feet that already bore countless scars had now gained many new injuries, mostly blood marks left from burst blisters, densely scattered.

"You walked here?" Ning Fuyi looked up to let Su Mo see her lips clearly, her voice somewhat low.

Su Mo nodded.

Ning Fuyi's eyelashes trembled a few times, then she reached out her hand, her palm mixed with demonic energy as she gently passed over both feet. The blood marks gradually healed as the demonic energy covered them.

Jiuying tightened her grip on Jiang Li's sleeve, signaling her to look at Chu Qingqiu. The surrounding aura seemed to have condensed into a wall, so thick it wouldn't dissipate.

However, Ning Fuyi quickly finished treating her wounds, swiftly stood up, and returned to stand beside Chu Qingqiu.

Su Mo's gaze also swept over Chu Qingqiu, as if she knew everything, but said nothing.